

Mara Holt

Human / 27 / Road-watch escort & shield protector



Broad-shouldered and square-faced, with close-cropped brown hair, a crooked healed nose, and a pale rope scar across her left palm. Her leather armour is carefully restitched at the right shoulder.

Personality: Patient, practical, and quietly funny. She mends other people's straps and remembers who dislikes cold tea. Under stress, she gives jobs before asking what others have noticed.

Background: Mara left the road watch when ordered to save a merchant's cargo before stranded passengers. During the flood, she braced the wagon and returned for its last injured guard.

Goal: Make the company's charter a welcome sight to frightened travellers, regardless of who can pay.

Bond: Pebb talked a hostile tollkeeper into opening shelter during the flood. Mara trusts their judgement and gives negotiations time.

"Tell me when you are ready. I will hold."

Mother tongue: River Crown · **Familiar craft:** Tailor

STR	CON	DEX	SIZ	INT	POW	CHA	
15	13	13	14	11	10	10	
HP	MAJOR WOUND	POWER POINTS	HERO POINTS	ARMOUR	COMBAT ORDER	MOVEMENT	DAMAGE MOD.
14/14	7	10/10	2	2 AP	9	15 m	+1D4

WEAPONS

ATTACK	SKILL	DAMAGE	SIZE / RANGE
Arming sword	58%	1D8+1D4+1	Medium / 2 m
Shortbow	39%	1D8	- / 75 m
Dagger	58%	2D4+1	Light / 2 m
Thrown dagger	39%	2D4+1	Light / 15 m
Large shield	58%	1D6+1D4	Huge / 2 m
Unarmed	33%	1D3+1D4	Light / 2 m

Ready: Arming sword and large shield; shortbow slung.

TALENTS

Protector

Shield Cover

Favoured Weapon (Arming Sword)

Athletics Expertise (Climbing)

EQUIPMENT & SUPPLIES

CARRIED	QUANTITY / SUPPLY
Leather armour	1, worn
Arming sword, shortbow, dagger	1 each
Large shield	1
Backpack	1
Rope	10 m
Flint and tinder	1 set
Waterskin	2 days water
Provisions	14 days
Bedroll	1
Climbing kit	1
Healing kit	1 kit; 5 uses
Lantern and oil	1 each
Quiver and arrows	1 quiver; 20 arrows

Money: 74 SP

Listed load: 18 ENC · **Capacity:** 29 ENC

Condition: Rested and uninjured.

Skills & talents

RESISTANCES

Dodge	53%
Persistence	30%
Resilience	33%

COMBAT

Close Combat	58%
Ranged Combat	39%
Unarmed Combat	33%

PRACTICAL

Athletics	58%
Deception	24%
Driving	24%
Healing	31%
Influence	35%
Mechanisms	24%
Perception	41%

PRACTICAL, CONTINUED

Performance	20%
Riding	23%
Sailing	24%
Streetwise	20%
Trade	21%

CRAFT

Tailor	21%
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KNOWLEDGE

Military Tactics	51%
Natural Lore	31%

CULTURE

Whitewater	31%
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LANGUAGE

River Crown	61%
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TALENTS

Protector

When an adjacent ally is hit by an attack Mara is aware of, spend her **base Reaction** to Parry with her ready shield at **58%**. Success reduces damage normally; failure leaves the ally hit. Ranged attacks use Active Guard eligibility and modifiers. The ally keeps their Reaction, but cannot also React to this attack. Mara's extra off-hand Reaction cannot be used.

Shield Cover

While Mara is aware and her large shield is ready, ranged attacks and individually targeted Projected Shaping against her suffer **-1P**. This costs no Reaction and applies before Active Guard. Use only the best Shield Cover or terrain penalty. Dodge and Active Guard remain available. This gives no protection against areas or Direct Harm.

Favoured Weapon (Arming Sword)

Damaging attacks with Mara's arming sword gain **+1 damage** before Parry and armour, already included on page 1. This includes a primitive arming sword, but not use as an improvised club. No bonus applies when normal damage is replaced, including Disarm, Trip, Shield Rush, Subdue, or an unopposed Critical. A Critical opposed by an ordinary Reaction retains the bonus.

Athletics Expertise (Climbing)

On **Athletics tests for climbing**, remove up to **1 remaining Penalty die** after ordinary Bonus/Penalty cancellation and before the final dice cap. This never creates Bonus dice and does not apply to other Athletics uses.